Experiment - 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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AIM

To demonstrate the development-to-production deployment workflow of a Zoho Creator application using the Environments feature.

INTRODUCTION

Applications that serve real users should not be changed directly while they are in use. Zoho Creator addresses this with the Environments feature, a multi-stage deployment space in which an application can be tested and published without affecting the production application. An application passes through three environments:

Environment	Purpose
Development	The environment in which the application is built, configured and changed. Changes made here do not reach end users.
Stage	An intermediate testing environment in which the application is deployed and tested before release.
Production	The live environment in which the tested application is published and used by end users.

Table 1: Environments in Zoho Creator

Separating the environments allows new changes to be verified in Stage before they are released, so that the live application in Production is not disturbed by incomplete or untested work.

Application Used

Hotel Booking – an application to manage room reservations, guest details and booking status. It is used here as the application that is moved through the three environments.

Why Use Environments?

- **Safe testing:** new reservation forms, workflows and notifications can be tested without affecting guests who are already booking rooms.
- **Controlled releases:** only an application that has passed testing in Stage is published to Production.
- **Traceability:** each release can be followed through the Version History of the Environments page.
- **Reduced risk:** errors are found before release, which lowers the chance of downtime or data problems in the live system.
- **Clear roles:** developers work in Development, testers verify in Stage and end users work in Production.

Deployment Workflow

Figure 1 shows the deployment workflow as a conceptual diagram. It is not a screenshot of the Zoho Creator interface.

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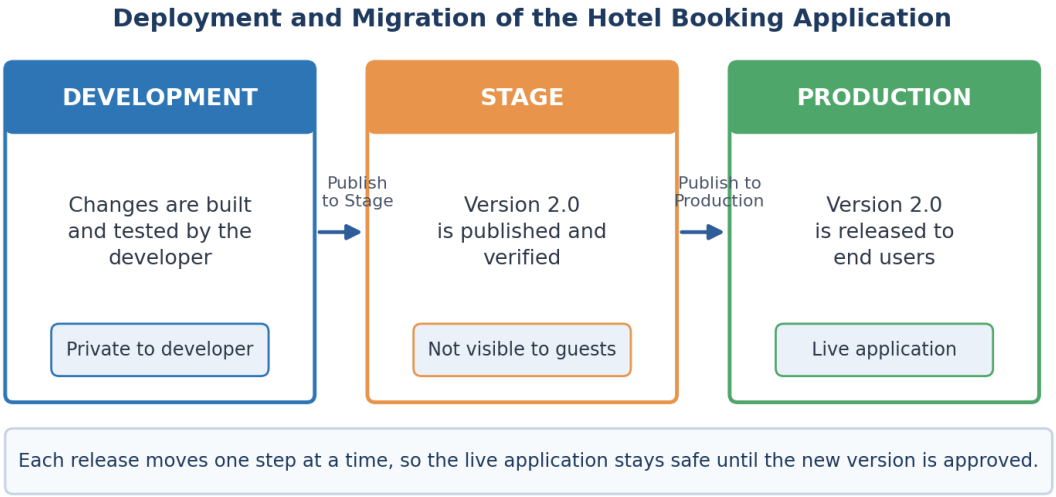


Figure 1: Deployment Workflow from Development to Production (Conceptual Diagram)

Version and Status of Each Environment at Every Stage

	1. Initial state	2. After changes in Development	3. After publish to Stage	4. After publish to Production
Development	V1.0	V2.0 draft	V2.0	V2.0
Stage	V1.0	V1.0	V2.0	V2.0
Production	V1.0	V1.0	V1.0	V2.0
Status shown under the application name:	No changes available	Changes available	No changes available	No changes available

Figure 2: Version and Status of Each Environment at Every Stage (Conceptual Diagram)

PROCEDURE

The deployment follows the flow: Development Environment → Stage Environment → Production Environment.

Step 1: Open the Environments Page

In Zoho Creator, open **Applications** and select **Hotel Booking** (created on Oct 06, 2026). Changes are built and edited here.

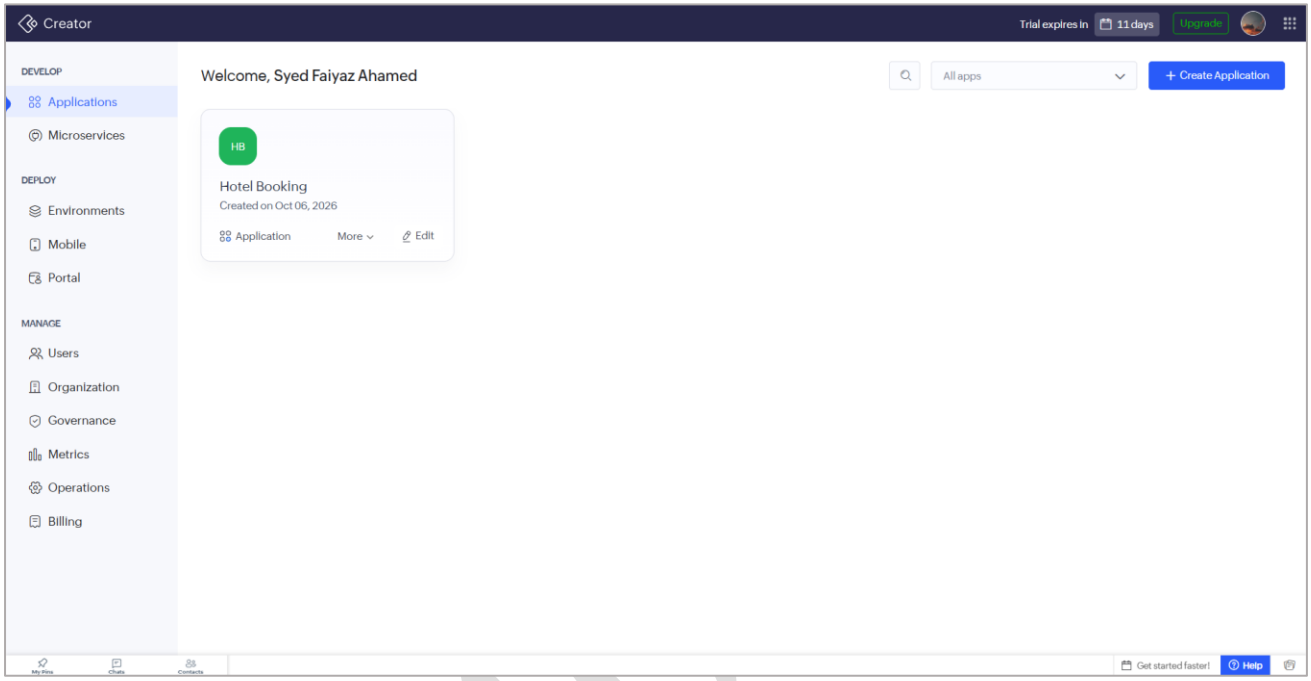


Figure 3: Applications dashboard showing the Hotel Booking application

Step 2: Open Environments and add the application

Under **Deploy**, click **Environments**. Stage and Production are both empty at first, so click **Add Application** to bring Hotel Booking into the deployment pipeline.

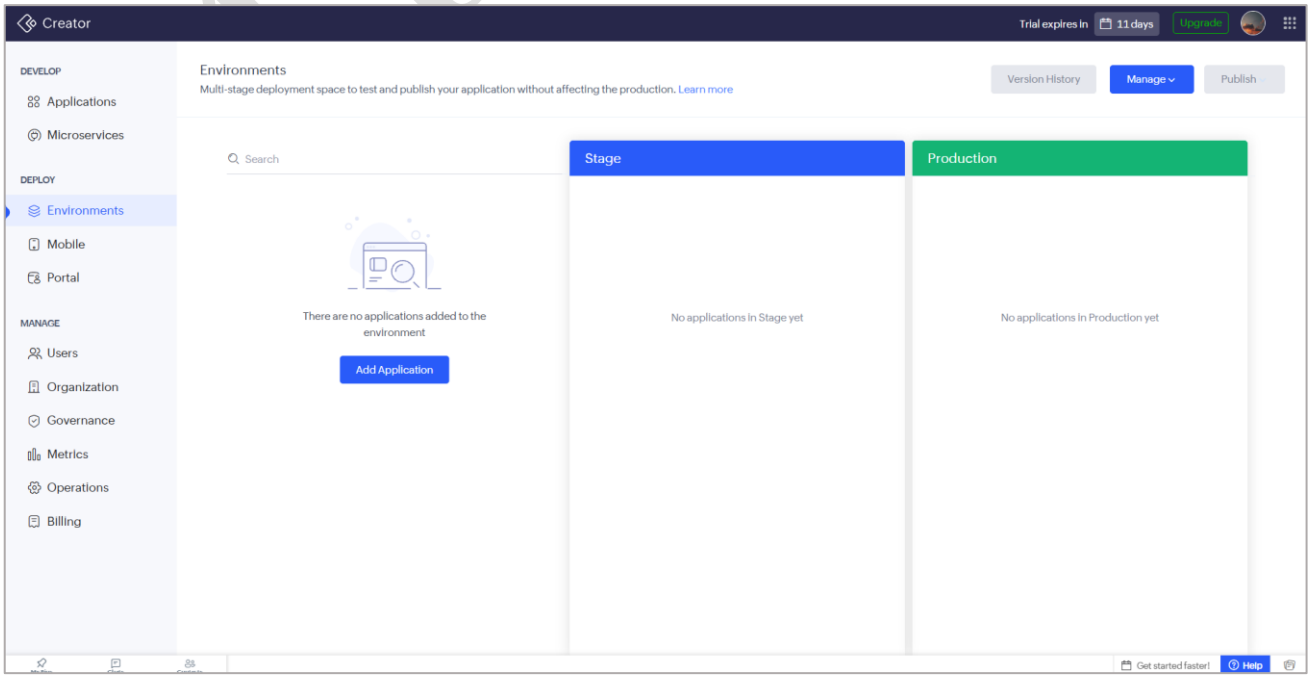


Figure 4: Empty Environments page with the Add Application button

Step 3: Publish the Baseline Version 1.0

Publish the application through Stage to Production so that version **1.0** exists in both environments. After the form and report are edited in Development, the application shows **Changes available**, and the **Publish** button becomes active.

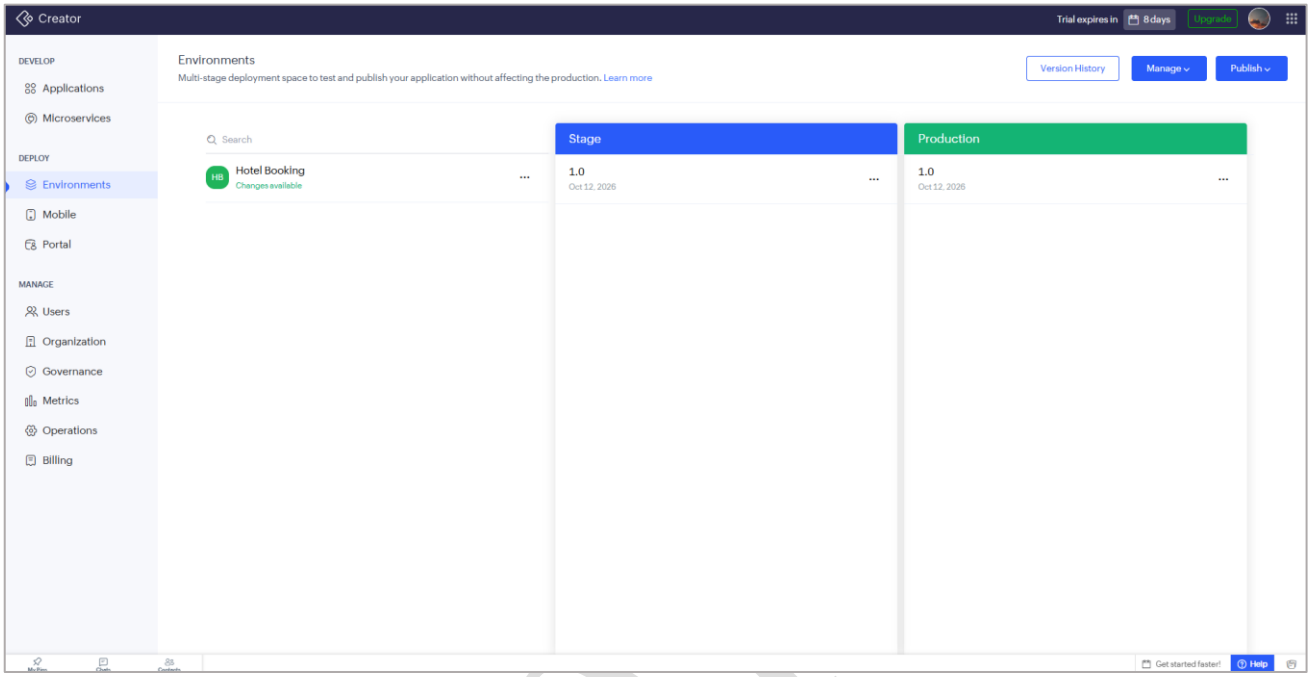


Figure 5: Version 1.0 in Stage and Production, with Changes available

Step 4: Publish to Stage and select components

Click **Publish → Stage**. The changed components are listed with indicators:

- **Alternate Contact Number**: a new field in the Contact Details section of the Hotel Room Booking form (green indicator).
- **Hotel Room Booking Report**: an existing report that was modified (orange indicator).

Click a component to see its difference, check that **Selected Components** shows 2, then click **Proceed**.

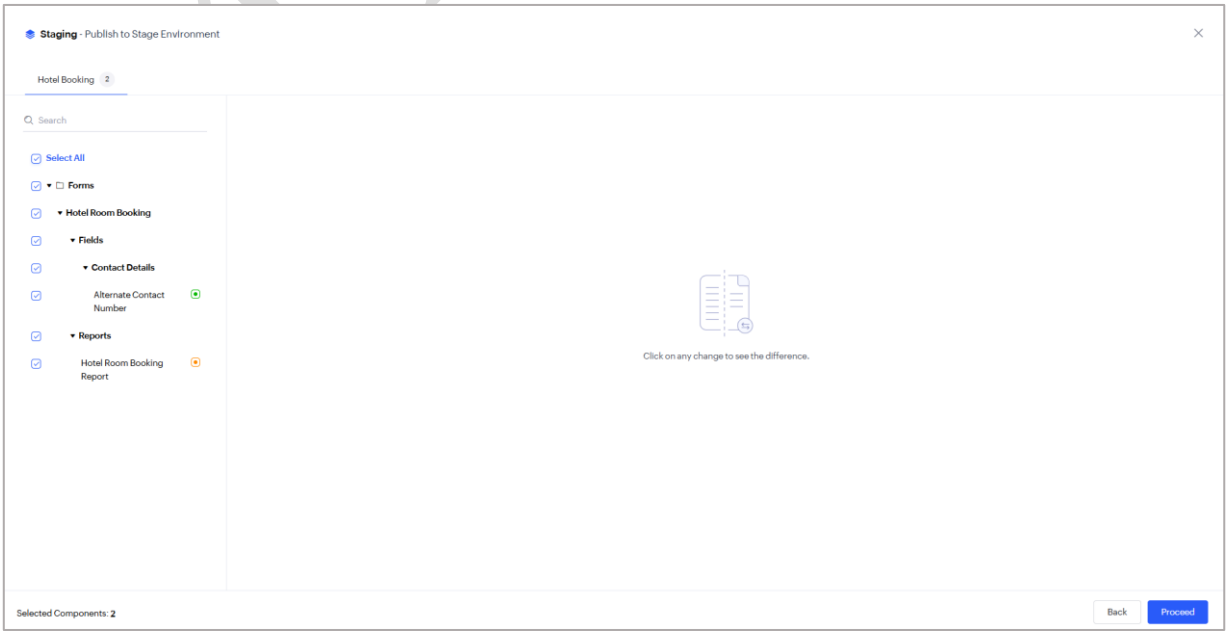


Figure 7:Publish to Stage, selecting the changed components

Step 5: Enter the Version Details

Enter the title "Version 2.0" and the description "Enhanced feature for better application", choose the type **Major** (enhancements and updates), and add an email address for notification. The screen shows the version change V1.0 → V2.0 and warns that the application goes into maintenance mode until it is published. Click **Publish**.

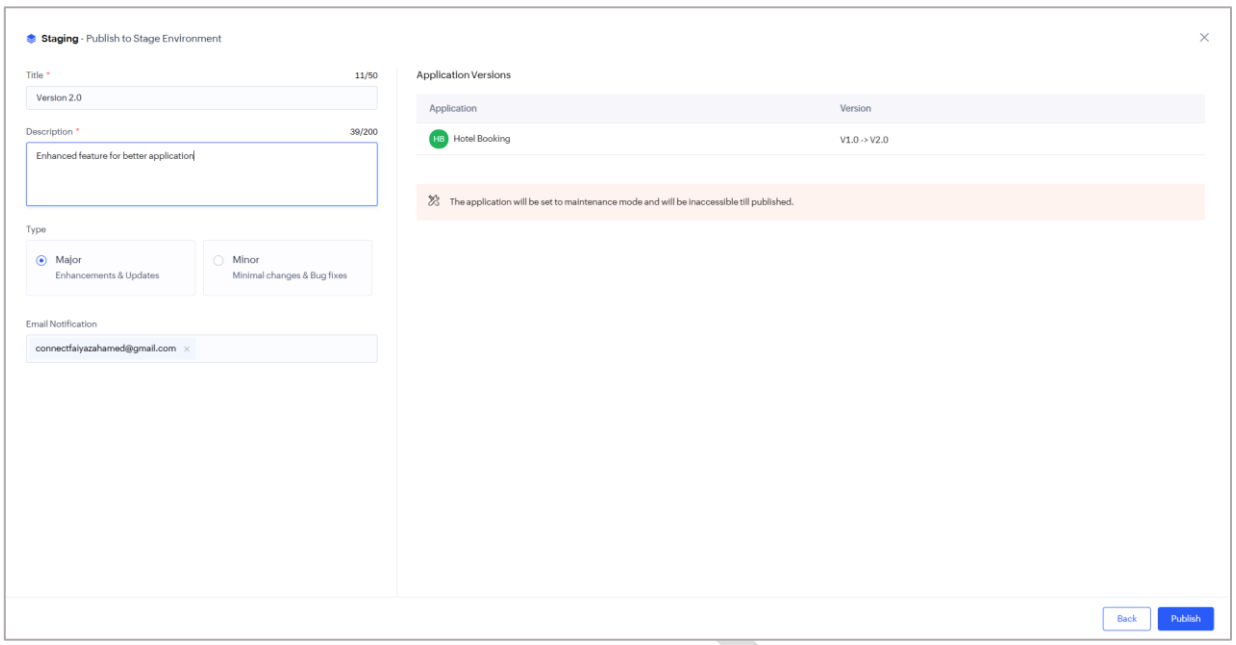


Figure 8: Version title, description, type and email notification

Step 6: Test the New Version in Stage

Check that the Alternate Contact Number field appears and saves correctly, that the Hotel Room Booking Report shows the expected records, and that existing workflows still work.

Step 7: Publish to Production

Click **Publish** → **Production**. Choose **Publish Now** (or **Publish Later** with a date, time and timezone), add the mail notification address, and confirm that the summary shows Version 2.0 for Hotel Booking. The same maintenance-mode warning applies. Click **Publish**.

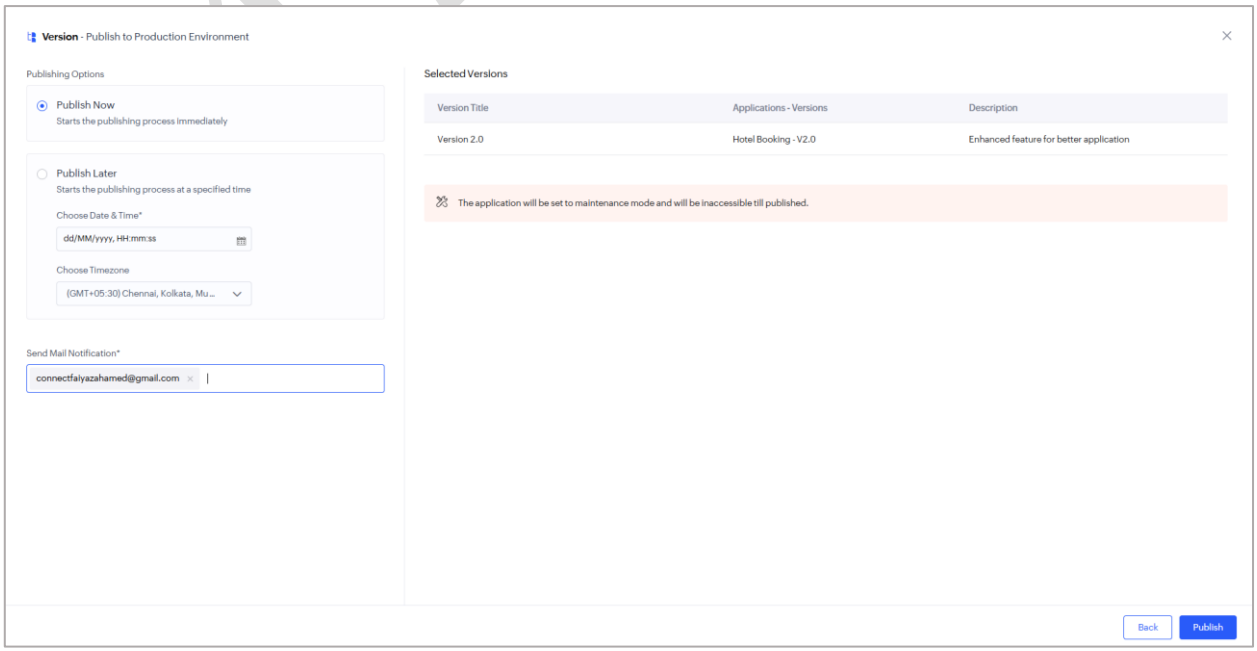


Figure 9: Publish to Production options

Step 8: Verify the Deployment

Return to **Environments** and confirm the version in both columns and the application status.

OUTPUT:

The Environments page changed as follows during the deployment:

Stage of deployment	Stage version	Production version	Application status
Before the new changes are published	1.0	1.0	Changes available
After publishing to Stage	2.0	1.0	Locked
After publishing to Production	2.0	2.0	No changes available

After the Stage publish, Stage shows 2.0 while Production still serves 1.0 to live users.

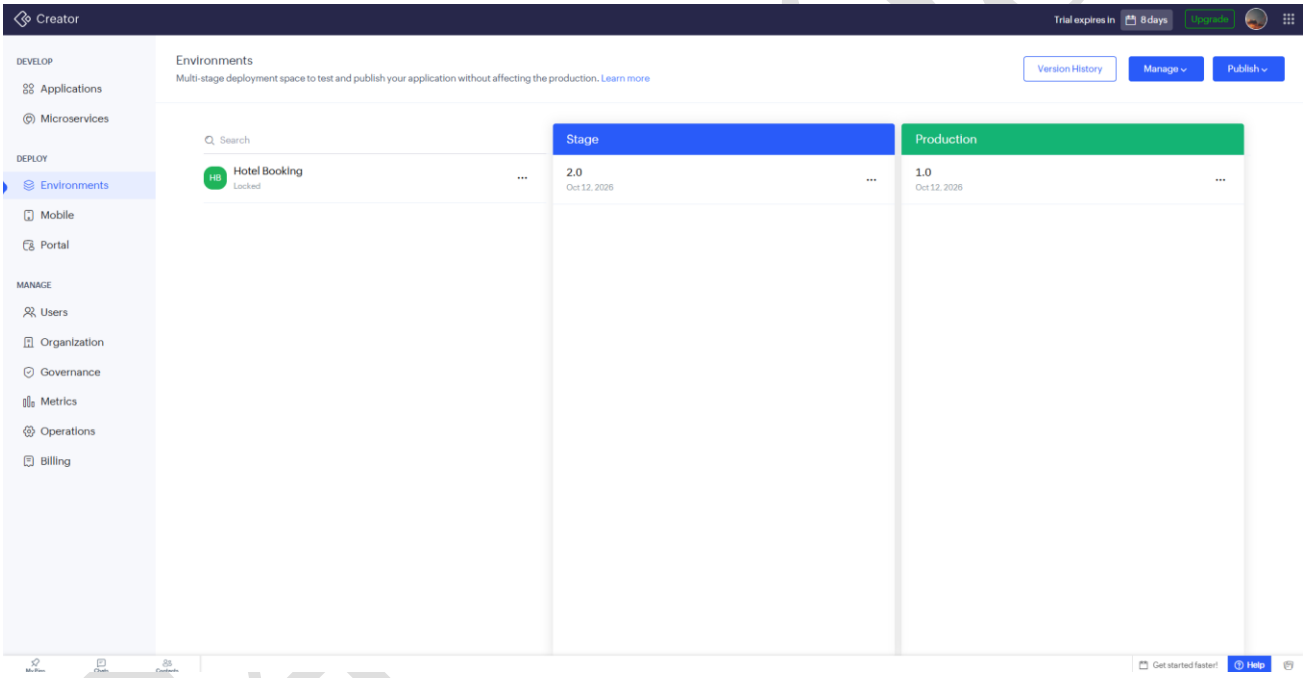


Figure 10: Stage at version 2.0, Production at 1.0, application locked

After the Production publish, both environments show 2.0.

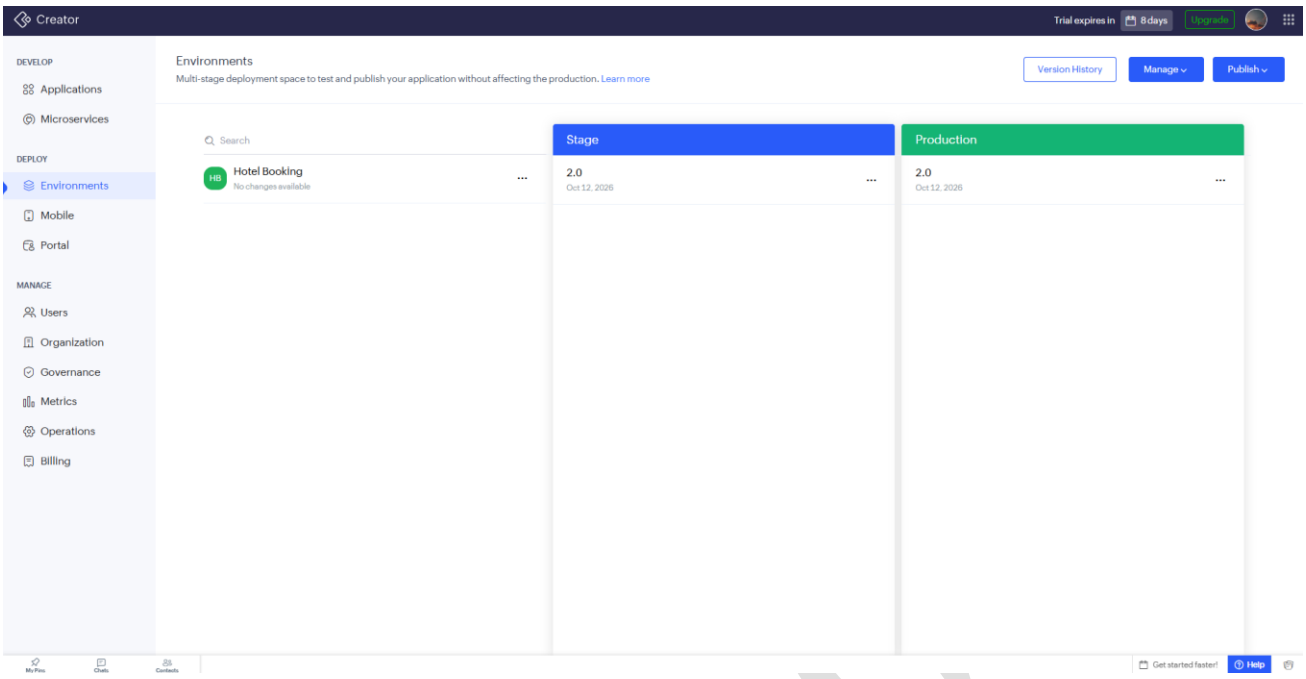


Figure 11: Stage and Production both at version 2.0, no changes available

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RESULT:

The Hotel Booking application was deployed successfully from Development through Stage to Production. Version 2.0, with the new Alternate Contact Number field and the modified Hotel Room Booking Report, is live in both environments, and the status reads "No changes available".